



(12) **United States Plant Patent**
van der Spek

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(54) **COREOPSIS PLANT NAMED ‘TWEETY’**

(50) Latin Name: *Coreopsis verticillata*
Varietal Denomination: **Tweety**

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(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this patent is extended or adjusted under 35 U.S.C. 154(b) by 39 days.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Coreopsis* plant named ‘Tweety’, characterized by its bright yellow-colored flowers, medium green-colored, deeply-dissected foliage having thread-like segments, low to moderate growth vigor, well-branched, upright-mounded, compact growth habit, is disclosed.

1 Drawing Sheet

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Latin name of genus and species of plant claimed: *Coreopsis verticillata*.

Variety denomination: ‘Tweety’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar of *Coreopsis* plant botanically known as *Coreopsis verticillata* and hereinafter referred to by the cultivar name ‘Tweety’. The new cultivar originated from an open pollination in 2005 in a controlled nursery location in Boskoop, The Netherlands between unknown male and female *Coreopsis verticillata* plants. The new cultivar was selected in 2007 in the nursery location in Boskoop, The Netherlands from the seedling results of the open pollination.

Asexual reproduction of the new cultivar by terminal stem cuttings since 2007 in Boskoop, The Netherlands has demonstrated that the new cultivar reproduces true to type with all of the characteristics, as herein described, firmly fixed and retained through successive generations of such asexual propagation.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following characteristics of the new cultivar have been repeatedly observed and can be used to distinguish ‘Tweety’ as a new and distinct cultivar of *Coreopsis* plant:

1. Bright yellow-colored flowers;
2. Medium green-colored, deeply-dissected foliage having thread-like segments;
3. Low to moderate growth vigor;
4. Well-branched, upright-mounded, compact growth habit.

Plants of the new cultivar differ from plants of possible *Coreopsis verticillata* parents primarily in growth habit. The new cultivar has a more mounded and compact growth habit.

Of the many commercially available *Coreopsis* cultivars, the most similar in comparison to the new cultivar is ‘Zagreb’, not patented. However, in side by side comparisons, plants of the new cultivar differ from plants of ‘Zagreb’ in at least the following characteristics:

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1. Plants of the new cultivar have a more compact-mounded growth habit, as measured by plant height, than plants of ‘Zagreb’;
2. Plants of the new cultivar have smaller inflorescences than plants of ‘Zagreb’; and
3. Plants of the new cultivar have narrower leaf segments than plants of ‘Zagreb’.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying photographs show, as nearly true as it is reasonably possible to make the same in color illustrations of this type, typical flower and foliage characteristics of the new cultivar. Colors in the photographs differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed description, which accurately describes the colors of ‘Tweety’. The plants were grown in 1.5 liter pots for one year in an outdoor nursery location located in Boskoop, The Netherlands.

FIG. 1 illustrates a side view of the overall growth and flowering habit of ‘Tweety’.

FIG. 2 illustrates a close-up view of an inflorescence of ‘Tweety’.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The new cultivar has not been observed under all possible environmental conditions to date. Accordingly, it is possible that the phenotype may vary somewhat with variations in the environment, such as temperature, light intensity, and day length, without, however, any variance in genotype.

The chart used in the identification of colors described herein is The R.H.S. Colour Chart of The Royal Horticultural Society, London, England, 2007 edition, except where general color terms of ordinary significance are used. The color values were determined under natural light conditions in The Netherlands.

The following descriptions and measurements describe plants produced from cuttings and grown under conditions comparable to those used in commercial practice. The plant data was taken in September 2010 on 1.5-liter container grown plants grown for one year in an outdoor nursery in Boskoop, The Netherlands with daytime temperatures between 12° C. and 28° C. and nighttime temperatures

between 4° C. and 16° C. No pinching, growth retardants or photoperiodic treatments were used.

Botanical classification: *Coreopsis verticillata* cultivar Tweety.

Parentage: 5

Female parent.—Unknown *Coreopsis verticillata* plant.

Male parent.—Unknown *Coreopsis verticillata* plant.

Propagation:

Type cutting.—Terminal stem.

Time to initiate roots.—Approximately 21 days at 20° C.

Time to produce a rooted cutting.—Approximately 42 10 days at 20° C.

Root description.—Fibrous, thin, white in color.

Rooting habit.—Freely branching, dense.

Plant description:

Commercial crop time.—Approximately 10 to 12 weeks 15 from a rooted cutting to finish in a one-gallon container.

Growth habit and general appearance.—Herbaceous perennial, low to moderate growth vigor, well-branched, upright-mounded, compact growth habit. 20

Size.—Height from soil level to top of plant plane: Approximately 22.1 cm. Width: Approximately 20.0 cm.

Branching habit.—Freely branching, pinching improves basal branching. Quantity of lateral 25 branches per plant: Approximately 54.

Lateral branch.—Strength: Strong. Length: Approximately 8.9 cm. Diameter: Approximately 2.0 mm. Length of central internode: Approximately 2.8 cm. Texture: Slightly glossy, glabrous. Color of young 30 and mature stems: 144A.

Foliage description:

General description.—Quantity of leaves per lateral branch: Approximately 14. Fragrance: None detected. Form: Single. Arrangement: Opposite.

Leaves.—Aspect: Acute angle to stem; perpendicular to 35 obtuse angle to stem with age. Shape: Upper leaves linear, lower leaves overall shape ovate having three to five linear lobes having a thread-like appearance. Margin: Entire, deeply dissected. Apex of divisions: Acuminate. Base: Sessile, truncate. Venation pattern: 40 Pinnate. Length of mature leaf: Approximately 3.3 cm. Width of mature leaf: 2.9 cm. Texture of upper surface: Very slightly glossy, glabrous. Texture of lower surface: Moderately glossy, glabrous. Color of upper and lower surfaces of young foliage: 143B with 45 indistinguishable venation. Color of upper and lower surfaces of mature foliage: 147B indistinguishable venation.

Flowering description:

Flowering habit.—‘Tweety’ is freely flowering under 50 outdoor growing conditions with substantially continuous blooming from spring through autumn and year-round in greenhouse environment.

Lastingness of individual inflorescence on the plant.— Approximately 14 days.

Inflorescence description: 55

General description.—Type: Daisy-type composite, actinomorphic. Persistent. Shape: Round. Aspect: Erect. Arrangement: Terminal capitulum, positioned above and below the foliage. Quantity per plant: Approximately 50. Diameter: Approximately 2.6 cm. 60 Depth: Approximately 8.0 mm. Fragrance: None detected.

Peduncle.—Strength: Strong. Aspect: Erect. Length: Approximately 3.4 cm. Diameter: Less than 1.0 mm. Texture: Glabrous, slightly glossy. Color: 143B.

Bud.—Rate of opening: Generally takes 4 to 5 days for bud to progress from first color to fully open flower.

Quantity per plant: Approximately 100.

Bud just before opening.—Shape: Oblate. Diameter: Approximately 4.0 mm. Depth: Approximately 3.0 mm. Color: 152A to 152B.

Ray florets.—Quantity per inflorescence: Approximately 8. Arrangement: In a single whorl. Aspect: Slightly concave. Shape: Elliptic. Margin: Entire. Apex: Three acute tips. Base: Cuneate. Length: Approximately 1.2 cm. Width: Approximately 5.0 mm. Texture of upper and lower surfaces: Glabrous, axially ribbed. Color of upper and lower surfaces when first open: 13A. Color of upper and lower surfaces when fully open: 12A, transitioning to 14B with age.

Disc florets.—Quantity per inflorescence: Approximately 35. Arrangement: Massed in center of inflorescence. Shape: Tubular, lower 90% fused. Margin: Entire. Apex: Five acute tips. Base: Fused. Length: Approximately 8.0 mm. Diameter: Approximately 2.0 mm. Texture: Slightly glossy, glabrous. Color of upper or inner surface when first and fully open: 151D with tips of 1A. Color of lower or outer surface when fully open: 151D with tips of 1A.

Disc.—Diameter: Approximately 6.0 mm. Depth: Approximately 5.0 mm.

Receptacle.—Shape: Cone. Height: Approximately 1.0 mm. Diameter at base: Approximately 2.0 mm. Color: 144B to 144C.

Phyllaries.—Quantity per inflorescence Approximately 20. Arrangement: In two equally divided whorls. Base of outer bracts fused into cup-shaped base, inner bracts surround receptacle, slightly imbricate, held close to ray florets.

Outer phyllaries.—Shape of free portion: Lanceolate. Margin: Entire. Apex: Acute. Base: Fused. Length: Approximately 5.0 mm. Width: Approximately 1.0 mm. Texture of upper and lower surfaces: Glabrous, glossy. Color of upper and lower surfaces: 144B.

Inner phyllaries.—Shape: Ovate. Margin: Entire. Apex: Broadly acute. Base: Truncate. Length: Approximately 4.0 mm. Width: Approximately 2.5 mm. Texture of upper and lower surfaces: Glabrous, slightly glossy. Color of upper and lower surfaces: 152C to 152D.

Reproductive organs.—Androecium: Present on disc florets only. Stamen quantity: 5. Stamen length: Approximately 5.0 mm. Filament length: Approximately 3.0 mm. Filament color: 150C. Anther shape: Oblong, basifixed. Anther length: Approximately 2.0 mm. Anther color: 200A. Pollen amount: Moderate to abundant. Pollen color: 8A. Gynoecium: Present on ray and disc florets. Pistil quantity: 1 per floret. Pistil length: Approximately 8.0 mm. Stigma shape: Cleft. Stigma length: Approximately 1.0 mm. Stigma color: 13B. Style length: Approximately 5.0 mm. Style color: 154C to 154D. Ovary length: Approximately 2.0 mm. Ovary color: 151D.

Seed and fruit production: Neither seed nor fruit production has been observed.

Disease and pest resistance: Resistance to pathogens and pests common to *Coreopsis* has not been observed.

What is claimed is:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of *Coreopsis* plant named ‘Tweety’, substantially as herein shown and described.



FIG. 1



FIG. 2